

ADR-002: Adoption of the Conventional Commits Standard

Context

The project's Git history can quickly become difficult to read if each developer uses their own commit message format (e.g., 'wip', 'fix bug'). To facilitate teamwork, quickly understand the changes introduced by a pull request, and allow the automation of versioning and release notes (changelog) in our CI/CD pipelines (GitHub Actions), it is necessary to structure our commit messages.

Considered Options

- **Free commit messages:** No constraints, initial writing speed, but a chaotic history that is impossible to leverage for automation.
- **Custom internal convention:** Creating our own format. This would meet the need, but requires writing documentation and prolongs onboarding.
- **Conventional Commits:** Industry standard (based on the Angular convention) using strict prefixes (feat:, fix:, chore:, docs:, etc.).

Decision

Chosen decision: Use the Conventional Commits standard.

Justification: It is a recognized standard mastered by a large majority of developers. This standard integrates perfectly with our previous choice of continuous integration tool, allowing the automation of semantic versioning (SemVer) and changelog generation via existing tools. This brings rigor to the source code without having to invent and maintain our own standard.

Consequences

- **Positive:** Uniform, clean Git history, easily filterable by change type.
- **Positive:** Ability to automatically generate a CHANGELOG.md file and automate releases.
- **Negative:** Slight friction when writing commits to get used to the prefixes and formatting rules.